

LUNA HOU

EDUCATION

M.F.A. in Writing (Fiction)

Columbia University – New York, NY | Incoming Fall 2026

B.A. in English, Minor in Creative Writing, *summa cum laude*

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill – Chapel Hill, NC | May 2025

Honors Thesis Title: “Song Cycle.” A 1000-line manuscript of poems.

WRITING INSTRUCTION & TUTORING

Guest Instructor, Introduction to Poetry

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill – Chapel Hill, NC | Nov 2025

- Led one class session for an undergraduate poetry course, teaching a lesson on poetic form
- Prepared original materials and facilitated discussion, close reading, and guided writing exercises

Undergraduate Course Instructor

Carolina Students Taking Academic Responsibility through Teaching – Chapel Hill, NC | Aug 2023 – May 2024

- Led a weekly, 2-hour class of 10 undergraduates in the spring semester, moderating seminar-style analytical discussions and creative writing workshops focused on original student poems
- Provided detailed constructive feedback on academic and creative work via written comments on weekly assignments and one-on-one conferences, focusing on strength and clarity of literary analysis and craft-based revision strategies
- Designed a detailed syllabus for a semester-long course, including course readings and textbooks, assignments, presentation slides, and final project instructions to create a collaborative literary zine
- Researched contemporary Asian American poetry under the supervision of a faculty mentor, with a focus on 21st-century queer voices in relation to ongoing social, political, and historical movements

English as a Second Language Instructor

DanSummit – Remote | Sep 2019 – Jan 2022

- Tutored 3 students in English, helping to develop their reading, writing, and speaking skills
- Provided structured, individualized verbal and written feedback on homework and class assignments on a weekly basis to guide student learning and growth

English as a Second Language Instructor

DanSummit – Lin'an, Hangzhou, Zhejiang, China | July 2019

- Supervised a group of seven students from 9am-9pm, six days a week
- Facilitated daily lessons and team-building activities to strengthen students' English language and leadership skills, including instruction in grammar, oral presentation, and professional writing

ADDITIONAL TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Lead Piano Instructor

Meadowlark Music School – Chapel Hill, NC | Apr 2025 – Present

- Plan and lead weekly individual lessons for students with a focus on technique, music theory, and joy, nurturing creativity, confidence, and resilience
- Mentor students of diverse skill levels, ages, backgrounds, and learning styles

EDITORIAL EXPERIENCE

Prose Reader

Bull City Press – Durham, NC | Jun 2025 – Present

- Review high volumes of fiction and nonfiction submissions with attention to craft and literary merit
- Contribute to a small, collaborative team to discuss submissions, offer editorial feedback, and select the strongest manuscripts for publication

Editor in Chief

Cellar Door Literary Magazine – Chapel Hill, NC | May 2024 – May 2025

- Oversaw the publication of UNC's oldest literary magazine, including print and online submission selection, layout and design, copyedits, and planning a reading to recognize magazine contributors
- Communicated with administration and publishing companies concerning finances and publicity

Curator

COALESCE Exhibition – Hillsborough, NC | Aug 2024 – Jan 2025

- Evaluated poetry submissions for strong technical quality and artistic vision
- Collaborated with organizers to select a diverse representation of artists to participate in exhibition

Poetry Editor

Cellar Door Literary Magazine – Chapel Hill, NC | May 2023 – May 2024

- Led a staff of nine readers to select poetry submissions of the highest caliber to be published
- Acted as a liaison between staff, authors, and editorial board to assemble and refine submissions

Editorial Intern

Hachette Book Group: Algonquin Books – New York City, NY | Jan 2024 – May 2024

- Logged, reviewed, and drafted incisive reader's reports on literary fiction and nonfiction manuscripts
- Participated in weekly editorial meetings, offering insights on content quality and appeal based on industry and entertainment trends and recording meeting notes
- Provided administrative support for editors; crafted paperback materials for forthcoming titles

Poetry Editor

Short Story UNC – Chapel Hill, NC | Apr 2022 – Aug 2023

- Greenlighted poems to be published in specialized dispensers throughout the local community
- Coordinated and co-judged 2 annual writing contests to recognize outstanding writers on campus

HONORS & AWARDS

- 2025 Pushcart Prize Nominee, *Fractured Lit*
- 2025 Katharine Bakeless Nason Participant Scholar in Fiction, Bread Loaf Writers' Conference
Offered to applicants at the early stages of their writing career whose writing shows exceptional promise. Scholarships cover tuition, room, and board at the conference.
- 2025 Fiction Participant, Kenyon Writers Workshop
- 2025 Dorianne Laux Poetry Prize Winner, North Carolina State University Poetry Contest
The annual NC State Poetry Contest is a free literary competition open to all North Carolina residents. It remains one of the largest free-to-enter poetry contests in the South.
- 2024 Shorter Fiction Prize Winner, North Carolina State University Fiction Contest
The annual NC State Fiction Contest is a free literary competition open to all North Carolina residents. It remains one of the largest free-to-enter fiction contests in the South.
- 2024 Fiction Scholar, Juniper Summer Writing Institute
Attended on full scholarship.
- 2024 Suzanne Bolch Summer Travel Scholarship Winner, UNC-Chapel Hill
Provides summer support to a creative writing minor who seeks to develop an original, independent project designed to stimulate and expand the writer's imagination and artistic vision.
- 2023 One Teen Story Ages 18-19 National Category Winner, One Story
Wrote a short story singularly selected from over 500 submissions as the Ages 18-19 National Category Winner of One Teen Story, a free national writing competition for all writers ages 13-19.
- 2021 Summer Bridge Scholar, UNC-Chapel Hill
- 2020 National Gold Medal in Flash Fiction, Scholastic Art & Writing Awards

PUBLICATIONS

Creative Writing

- forthcoming* "The Dragonfly," *Uncanny Magazine*
- 2025 "Moon Rabbit," *Fractured Lit*
- 2023 "Railroads," *One Teen Story*

Invited Readings

- 2025 Featured Writer, Common Roots Festival, North Carolina Asian Americans Together. Durham, NC. – May 17th, 2025
- 2025 Featured Poet, Bodies in Motion: The Poet in Diaspora, Indigena Collective. Raleigh, NC. – April 13th, 2025

- 2025 Featured Poet, Women's History Month Celebration, Town of Carrboro. Carrboro, NC. – March 1st, 2025
- 2024 Featured Writer, Bull City Press Reading Series, Bull City Press. Durham, NC. – July 27th, 2024
- 2024 Featured Poet, Women's History Month Celebration, Town of Carrboro. Carrboro, NC. – March 1st, 2024
- 2023 Featured Poet. Coalesce exhibition, Orange County Arts Commission. Hillsborough, NC. – January 5th, 2023

Interviews

- 2023 "Q&A by Patrick Ryan," *One Story*
- 2023 "Student Spotlight: Luna Hou," UNC English & Comparative Literature Department

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT

Vice President

Asian American Creative Writing Collective – Chapel Hill, NC | May 2024 – May 2025

- Organized semesterly open mics for students to showcase their creative work in the local community
- Assisted with the advertising, formatting, and selection of pieces for literary magazine *Infusions*
- Guided workshops, discussions, and writing exercises during bimonthly meetings

Publicity Chair

Asian American Creative Writing Collective – Chapel Hill, NC | May 2023 – May 2024

- Facilitated connections with other organizations, helping to plan and promote collaborative events
- Managed club social media, designing bimonthly Instagram posts and other promotional materials

Research Intern

Southern Oral History Program – Chapel Hill, NC | Aug 2023 – Dec 2023

- Conducted and transcribed two oral history interviews for Southern Mix, a project aiming to record and amplify the diverse and authentic experiences of Asians and Asian Americans in the South
- Designed an ethnopoetic zine combining original oral history research and secondary scholarship